

The Twelfth Regular Meeting of the Medford School Committee

Monday, June 13, 2022

Regular Meeting: 6:00 PM

To be held at the Howard Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall.

Join Zoom Meeting

<https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/91697745538>

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Agenda

- I. Roll Call for Attendance of Members and the Student Representatives
- II. Salute the Flag
- III. Good of the Order
- IV. Consent Agenda
 - Bills and Payrolls
 - Regular School Committee Meeting Minutes, 6.6.2022
- V. Report of Subcommittees
- VI. Report of the Superintendent
 - 1. Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent
 - 2. SEPAC End of Year Report, Presented by Ms. Alex Lauric and Ms. Tonya Sullivan, Co-chairs of the Special Education Parent Advisory Council
 - 3. Approval of the 2022-2023 District Calendar - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent
 - 4. Update on MPS Security Protocol - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent and Dr. Peter Cushing, Assistant Superintendent

5. Update on Implementation of NWEA MAP - Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent
6. FY 23 MPS Operating Budget Update - Assistant Superintendent of Finance and Operations David Murphy

VII. Presentations of the Public (not to begin before 7:00 pm)

“Regular Meetings of the School Committee include this ‘Presentations of the Public’ agenda item to give any resident the opportunity to place a presentation before the School Committee. A resident may only present once at any meeting.

These presentations are an opportunity for the public to make a presentation to the Committee but are not opportunities for dialog with the Committee. If one or more members of the Committee wishes to have a conversation about the topic presented, a member may request that the item be added to a subsequent Regular Meeting.

The details for submitting a presentation can be found within the policy BEDH, Public Comment and Presentations of the Public”

Pursuant to policy BEDH, Public Comment and Presentations of the Public - any resident in the audience may be given permission to speak once on any item on the agenda for up to three (3) minutes. The speaker is expected to keep their comments to the item on the agenda. The speaker must begin their comments by providing their full name and full Medford street address where they reside. A welcoming, inclusive community is both a value of the School Committee and an aspirational goal. We ask for your help in achieving this goal and value your perspective. Employees of the Medford Public Schools are exempt from the residency requirement of this policy. The voice of our employees is welcomed on all matters before this body. When a non-Medford-resident employee is participating in public comment or submitting a presentation of the public they will include their home address and identify themselves as an employee of the Medford Public Schools.

VIII. Continued Business

- Dress Code Policy - approved by Rules and Policy Subcommittee on 5.25.2022

It is the policy of the Committee that the student and their parent/guardian/caregiver hold the primary responsibility in determining the student’s personal attire, hairstyle, jewelry, and personal items (e.g. backpacks, book bags). Schools are responsible for ensuring that student attire, hairstyle, jewelry, and personal items do not interfere with the health or safety of any student and do not contribute to a hostile or intimidating environment for any student.

Core Values

In relation to student dress, the district’s core values are the following:

- Students should be able to dress and style their hair for school in a manner that expresses their individuality without fear of unnecessary discipline or body shaming;
- Students have the right to be treated equitably. Dress code enforcement will not create disparities, reinforce or increase the marginalization of any group, nor will it be more strictly enforced

against students because of racial identity, ethnicity, gender identity, gender expression, gender nonconformity, sexual orientation, cultural or religious identity, household income, body size/type, or body maturity;

- Students and staff are responsible for managing their personal distractions; and
- Students should not face unnecessary barriers to school attendance.

Universal Dress Code

Students must wear:

- Top (shirt, blouse, sweater, sweatshirt, tank, etc.);
- Bottom (pants, shorts, skirt, dress, etc.); and
- Footwear.

This policy permits additional student attire requirements when necessary to ensure safety in certain academic settings (e.g. physical education, science, or CTE courses), as well as recess. Additionally, this policy allows for reasonable variation in required student attire for participation in activities such as swimming or gymnastics.

Students may not wear clothing, jewelry, or personal items that:

- Are pornographic, contain threats, or promote illegal or violent conduct such as the unlawful use of weapons, drugs, alcohol, tobacco, or drug paraphernalia;
- Demonstrate hate group association/affiliation and/or use hate speech targeting groups based on race, ethnicity, gender, sexual orientation, gender identity, religious affiliation, or other protected groups;
- Intentionally show private parts (nipples, genitals, buttocks) or undergarments (with the exception of bra straps). Clothing must cover private parts in opaque (not able to be seen-through) material;
- Cover the student's face to the extent that the student is not identifiable (except clothing/headgear worn for a religious or medical purpose); or
- Demonstrate gang association/affiliation.

Attire worn in observance of a student's religion is not subject to this policy.

Clothing that displays profanity or other vulgarities can disrupt the learning environment. School leaders reserve the right to address disruptions on a case by case basis.

Enforcement

Principals are required to ensure that all staff are aware of and understand the core values and associated guidelines of this policy.

Staff will use reasonable efforts to avoid issuing dress code discipline to individuals in front of other students.

Staff will use reasonable efforts to limit disciplining or removing students from class as a consequence of wearing attire in violation of this policy unless the attire creates a substantial disruption to the educational environment, poses a hazard to the health or safety of others, or factors into a student behavior rule violation such as malicious harassment or the prohibition on harassment, intimidation, and bullying. Further, no student shall be referred to as "a distraction" due to their appearance or attire.

Typical consequences for a violation of this policy may include parent/guardian/caregiver contact or conference and the directive to cover, change, or remove the non-complying attire. A student may be instructed to leave their classroom briefly to change clothes. The Principal or their designee will notify a student's parent/guardian/caregiver of the school's response to violations of the student dress code policy.

IX. New Business

2022-38 Offered by Mea Mustone

Be it resolved that the Medford School Committee supports *An Act Relative to Healthy School Lunch (HD3159/SD1308)*.

Meeting Date Requested: 6/13/2022

Submitted Date: 6/8/2022

X. Reports Requested

XI. Condolences

XII. Next Meeting

XIII. Adjournment